

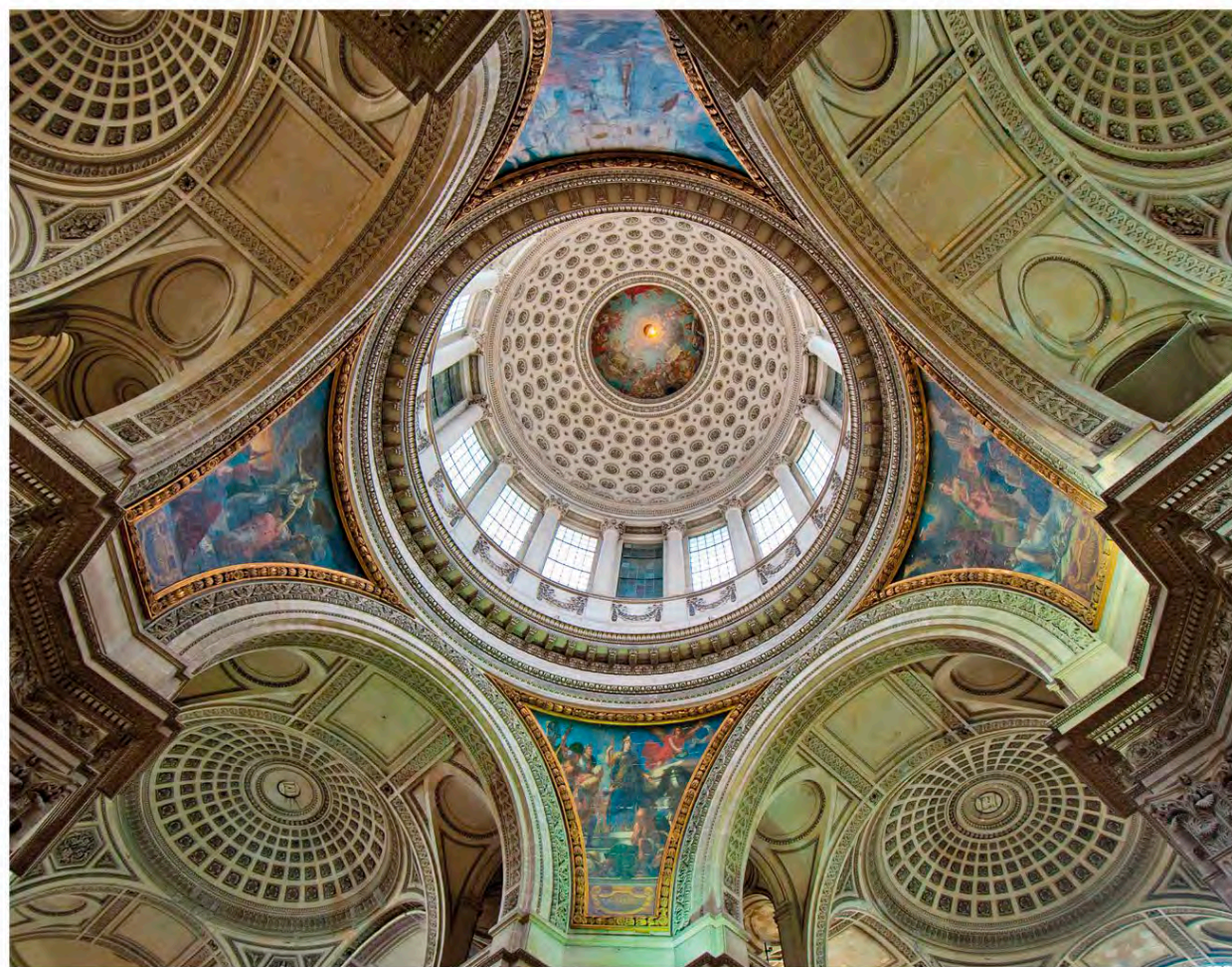
encapsulated by the 978-ft- (298-m-) long principal facade. Other than the cluster of gilded onion domes at one end, it is a precisely symmetrical structure, with five projecting blocks separated by giant columns, the whole multicolored and gilded.

Bom Jesus do Monte

Location Braga, Portugal

The significance of the church of Bom Jesus do Monte, built from 1784, lies less in the comparatively sober two-story church itself, its facade flanked by two bell towers, than in the extraordinary flight of 577 steps that leads to it. Their interlocking, zigzagging design, festooned with increasingly elaborate statuary and urns, is made even more memorable by a contrast of white stucco and gray, weathered stonework. However, they are more than simply an architectural tour de force; they are also packed with religious symbolism. At every intersection, there are fountains—

those at the lower levels representing the senses; those higher up, the



virtues. Similarly, each crossing point contains one of the 14 Stations of the Cross that document the Crucifixion of Jesus.

Catacombs of Paris

Location Paris, France

Also known as the Denfert Rochereau Ossuary, the Catacombs of Paris are located on Paris's Left Bank. There are perhaps 174 miles (280 km) of these tunnels, containing about 6–7 million bodies. They were not built as catacombs but instead were quarries, some dating back to Roman times, that were hurriedly pressed into service after 1786 to house the dead that could not be accommodated by the city's overflowing cemeteries. Only a few can be visited, but they make for a genuinely macabre experience, not least because in 1810 the inspector-general of the quarries ordered that the bones be precisely, almost decoratively stacked.

Panthéon, Paris

Location Paris, France

The Panthéon, in Paris's Latin Quarter, is among the city's most stately buildings. Designed by Jacques-Germain Soufflot and built between 1757 and 1790, it was originally intended as a church honoring the city's patron saint, St. Geneviève. But in 1791, the National Constituent Assembly, set up after the French Revolution, decreed it a mausoleum honoring the great and the good of France. Externally, its most dramatic features are its projecting central portico, its pediment carried by 22 Corinthian columns, and its high dome supported by a colonnaded drum. The interior is gloomily sepulchral, the result of its windows having been shuttered. However, the marbled grandeur of its Greek-cross plan is immediately evident.

▲ THE IMPOSING INTERIOR OF THE PANTHÉON IN PARIS

Custom House

Location Dublin, Ireland

Although it was rebuilt after being damaged in 1921, during the Irish War of Independence, James Gandon's Custom House, originally completed in 1791, remains among the most elegant of the city's many 18th-century buildings. Its most memorable facade faces south over the waters of the River Liffey. It is focused on a projecting, pedimented central block flanked by pairs of recessed Doric columns. These flanking elements are repeated in two further three-bay pavilions at each end of the building. A slim, elegant limestone dome rises over the pediment, its drum articulated by pairs of columns—four projecting discreetly outward. The lightly rusticated north facade is no less soberly Classical.

